

1. Functions in Philosophy of Language and Speech-Acts

1.1. Functions

1.1.1. Functional analysis by Cummins (1975)

Functional analysis starts with Hempel and Nagel, says Cummins. (A) The reason for functional characterization in science is to explain the presence of an item *i* in a system *s*. (B) For something to perform its function is for it to have certain function in *s*. Now we can say that presence of *i* in *s* characterized since *i* is present in *s* ***because*** it has certain effects on *s*.

References

Cummins, R., "Functional Analysis," *The Journal of Philosophy* **72**, pp. 741–760 (1975). <https://doi.org/10.2307/2024640>.